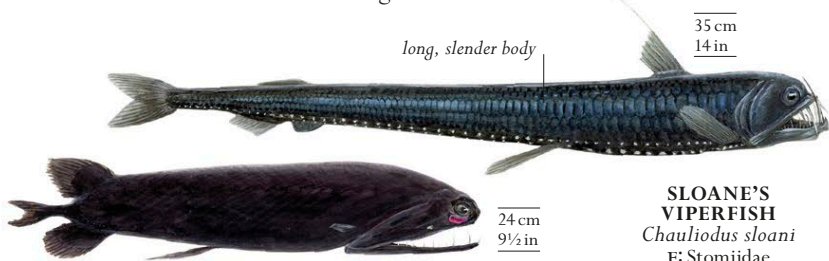


DRAGONFISH AND RELATIVES

A majority of these deep-sea fish have photophores to help them hunt, hide, and find mates. Most members of the order Stomiiformes are fearsome-looking predators, with large teeth and sometimes a long chin barbel.

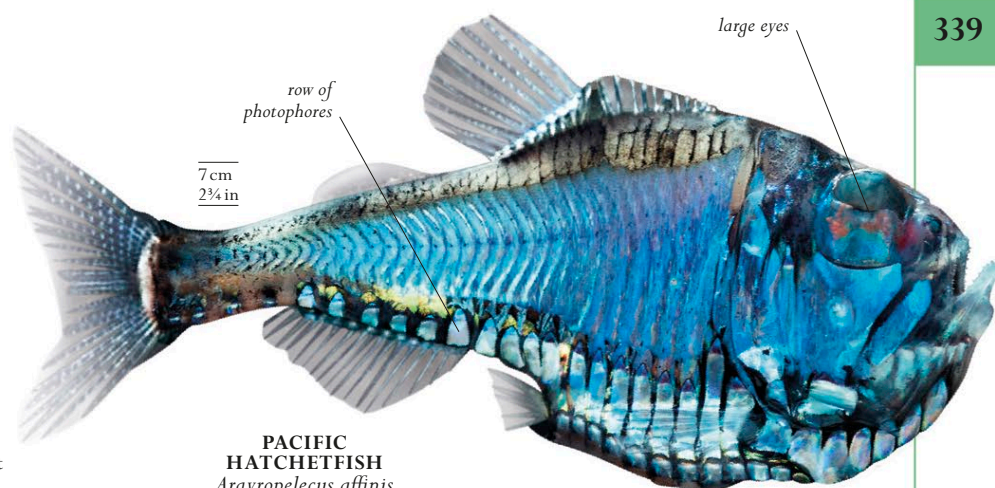


NORTHERN STOPLIGHT LOOSEJAW
Malacosteus niger
F: Stomiidae

Found globally in temperate, tropical, and subtropical oceans, this fish pinpoints its shrimp prey with a beam of red bioluminescent light invisible to the shrimp.

SLOANE'S VIPERFISH
Chauliodus sloani
F: Stomiidae

Viperfish have long, transparent fangs that protrude when the mouth is closed. Light from photophores confuses their prey in the depths of tropical and subtropical oceans.



PACIFIC HATCHETFISH
Argyrops affinis
F: Sternoptychidae

The silvery, thin body of this fish helps to camouflage and hide it from predators. It is found in temperate, tropical, and subtropical waters.

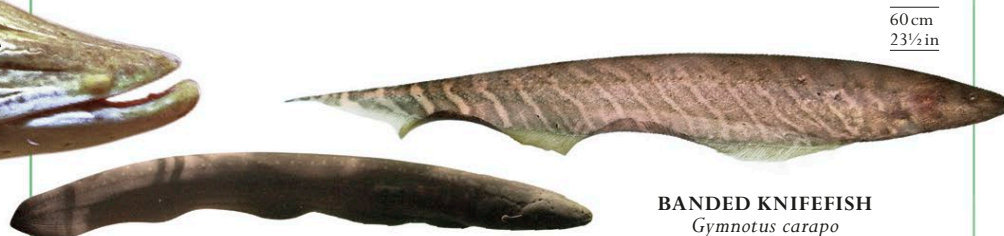


CHAIN PICKEREL
Esox niger
F: Esocidae

When hunting, this N. American pike uses delicate movements of its fins to hover motionless before striking with lightning speed.

KNIFEFISH

Knifefish have a sideways flattened, knife-like body, and a single long anal fin, which they use to glide backwards and forwards. The electric eel is atypical, with a long, round body. The Gymnotiformes live in fresh water and can produce electrical impulses.



BANDED KNIFEFISH
Gymnotus carapo
F: Gymnotidae

Found in murky wetlands in C. and S. America, this fish produces mild electric currents, which it uses to sense its surroundings.

ELECTRIC EEL
Electrophorus electricus
F: Gymnotidae

This large S. American fish can produce an electric shock of up to 600 volts – enough to kill other fish and stun a human.

SMELOTS AND RELATIVES

Smelts resemble small, slim salmon and, like them, most have an adipose fin on the back near the tail. Some of the Osmeriformes have a distinctive smell, like the European smelt, which smells like fresh cucumber.



EUROPEAN SMELT
Osmerus eperlanus
F: Opisthoproctidae

Resembling a cross between a herring and a trout, this fish is common in North Sea estuaries. In spring, smelt swim up rivers from the sea to spawn.



CAPELIN
Mallotus villosus
F: Osmeridae

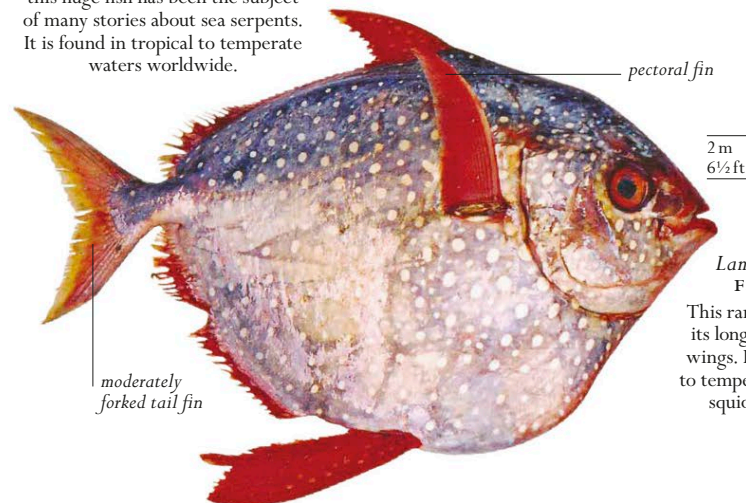
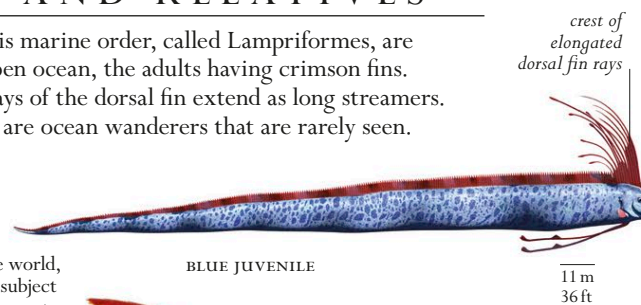
Found in cold Arctic and nearby waters, this small fish forms large shoals that are a crucial food source for many seabirds; its abundance or scarcity determines the breeding success of these birds.

OARFISH AND RELATIVES

The 23 members of this marine order, called Lampriformes, are colourful fish of the open ocean, the adults having crimson fins. In many species, the rays of the dorsal fin extend as long streamers. Most fish in this order are ocean wanderers that are rarely seen.

OARFISH
Regalecus glesne
F: Regalecidae

The longest bony fish in the world, this huge fish has been the subject of many stories about sea serpents. It is found in tropical to temperate waters worldwide.



OPAH
Lampris guttatus
F: Lampridae

This rarely seen fish beats its long pectoral fins like wings. Inhabiting tropical to temperate oceans, it eats squid and small fish.